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I-485, Application to Register Permanent Residence or Adjust Status

Use this form to apply for lawful permanent resident status if you are in the United States.

Forms and Document Downloads

[Form I-485 \(PDF, 1.15 MB\)](#)

[Instructions for Form I-485 \(PDF, 672.74 KB\)](#)

Form Details

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Edition Date

01/20/25. You can find the edition date at the bottom of the page on the form and instructions.

Dates are listed in mm/dd/yy format.

If you complete and print this form to mail it, make sure that the form edition date and page numbers are visible at the bottom of all pages and that all pages are from the same form edition. If any of the form's pages are missing or are from a different form edition, we may reject your form.

If you need help downloading and printing forms, read our [instructions](#).

Where to File

Where you file your Form I-485 depends on your eligibility category. Go to our [Direct Filing Addresses for Form I-485](#) page to see where you should file your application.

If you file at a USCIS lockbox, you may not receive an A-Number on your Form I-797, Notice of Action, due to a change in our business process. In these cases, we will send your A-Number in a second notice a few days after accepting your application.

When to File

In general, you may not file your Form I-485 until an immigrant visa is immediately available in your category. For information on the process of adjusting status as a permanent resident, and how to determine whether and when you are eligible to adjust status and file Form I-485, see our [Visa Availability and Priority Dates](#) and [Adjustment of Status Filing Charts from the Visa Bulletin](#) pages. For exceptions to the visa availability requirement, please check the Form I-485 instructions for your specific immigrant category for additional information.

Adjusting Status to become a U.S. permanent resident?



1. Your relative or employer files an immigrant petition for you.



2. Determine your petition type:

a. Visas for **immediate relative petitions** (spouses of U.S. citizens, unmarried children under 21 of U.S. citizens, parents of U.S. Citizens) are unlimited and always available. You may file your Form I-485 at the same time your U.S. citizen relative files a Form I-130.

b. Visas for **family-sponsored and employment-based preference petitions** are limited. You will need to consult the U.S. Department of State (DOS) Visa Bulletin to see if you can file your Form I-485. In order to use the Visa Bulletin, you will need to know your **priority date**.

go forward



3. What's my priority Date?

This is the date your relative or employer filed an immigrant petition on your behalf.



The date the Department of Labor accepts a labor certification for processing (when applicable).



4. Find out if you can file your I-485: Check uscis.gov/visabulletininfo
It will explain whether you should use the Application Final Action Dates chart or Dates for Filing Visa Applications chart to determine when you can file.

To use the charts:

1.

Find your visa type in the first column (on the left) of the appropriate chart (Family-sponsored, Employment-based, or Diversity Visa).

2.

Stay in that row and move directly to the right to find the corresponding date under the country of your birth (as listed in the boldface columns across the top).

3.

If the date on the chart is current ("C") or your priority date is earlier than the date on the chart, you may file your adjustment of status application, if otherwise eligible to do so.



U.S. Citizenship
and Immigration
Services

Filing Fee



You can find the filing fee for Form I-485 by visiting our [Fee Schedule](#) page.

USCIS no longer accepts payments made by personal or business check, money order, or cashier's check for forms filed by paper unless you qualify for an exemption. When filing by mail, you can pay by credit, debit, or prepaid card by completing [Form G-1450, Authorization for Credit Card Transactions](#), or you can make a payment directly from a U.S. bank account by completing [Form G-1650, Authorization for ACH Transactions](#).

If you qualify for an exemption from the requirement to use an electronic payment method, you will need to complete and file [Form G-1651, Exemption for Paper Fee Payment](#), along with submitting the correct payment.

Before sending your package to USCIS, watch [What and How to Pay](#) for additional guidance on how to file at the USCIS Lockbox with the correct payment.

USCIS continues to accept payments made through [Pay.gov](#) for applications and petitions [filed online](#).

For more information visit our [Filing Fees](#) webpage.

Checklist of Required Initial Evidence (for informational purposes only)

Save time by submitting all required initial evidence and supporting documentation at the same time you file Form I-485.

View the [checklist](#) of required initial evidence.

The checklist is an optional tool to use as you prepare your form, but does not replace statutory, regulatory, and form instruction requirements. Submitting all required initial evidence and supporting documentation at the same time you file Form I-485 may eliminate the need for us to issue a Request for Evidence to obtain additional documentation and evidence. This may also help avoid adjudication delays if we decide that you do not need to be interviewed.

If you are required to submit [Form I-693, Report of Immigration Medical Examination and Vaccination Record](#), or a partial Form I-693 (such as the Vaccination Record), you must submit it with your Form I-485. Otherwise, we may reject your Form I-485.

Effective April 4, 2024, any Form I-693 that was properly completed and signed by a civil surgeon on or after Nov. 1, 2023, does not expire, and can be used indefinitely as evidence to show that the applicant is not inadmissible on health-related grounds.

Form Filing Tips

Filing Tips: Review our [Tips for Filing Forms by Mail](#) page for information on how to ensure we will accept your form.

Don't forget to sign your form. We will reject any unsigned form.

Special Instructions

E-Notification: If you want to receive an e-mail and/or text message that we have accepted your form at a USCIS lockbox, complete [Form G-1145, E-Notification of Application/Petition Acceptance](#), and clip it to the first page of your form.

Afghan SIV

Effective July 20, 2022, we transitioned the responsibility to adjudicate Special Immigrant Visa (SIV) petitions filed by Afghans to the U.S. Department of State (DOS). Afghans who start the SIV application process on or after July 20, 2022, may seek classification as a special immigrant with DOS by filing Form DS-157 with the application for Chief of Mission approval. For more information, see instructions on the DOS website on [Special Immigrant Visas for Afghans – Who Were Employed by/on Behalf of the U.S. Government](#).

When filing Form I-485, you must supply evidence of an approved [Form I-360, Petition for Amerasian, Widow\(er\), or Special Immigrant](#), or a copy of the COM approval letter that also indicates approval of your Form DS-157.

INA 245(i)

If you are seeking to adjust status under the provisions of section 245(i) of the Immigration and Nationality Act, see [Supplement A](#) for additional instructions. You can find the filing fee for the Supplement A by visiting our [Fee Schedule](#) page.

Filing I-485 Supplement J

If you are filing Form I-485 together with a [Form I-140, Immigrant Petition for Alien Workers](#), that names you as the principal beneficiary, you do not need to file Supplement J.

However, you must file Supplement J if you are filing Form I-485 based on a previously filed Form I-140 or if you are requesting job portability to a new, permanent job offer under INA section 204(j). Visit our [Form I-485, Supplement J](#) page for specific instructions on when and how to file Supplement J.

Filing Form I-765 and Form I-131 with Form I-485

If you filed Form I-485 on or after July 30, 2007, and before April 1, 2024, and paid the required fee, you do not have to pay an additional fee to also file [Form I-765, Application for Employment Authorization](#), or [Form I-131, Application for Travel Documents, Parole Documents, and Arrival/Departure Records](#). However, if you file Form I-485 after April 1, 2024, you must pay additional fees to file Form I-765 and Form I-131, as listed on our [Fee Schedule](#) page. In either case, you may file these forms concurrently.

If you file Form I-131 concurrently with Form I-485 or while Form I-485 is pending and are requesting an advance parole document, select only item 5. A. in Part 1 of Form I-131. You do not need to provide a receipt number for your Form I-485 in the space provided for a receipt number if you are filing the Form I-131 concurrently with the Form I-485.

If you choose not to file Form I-765 and/or Form I-131 concurrently with your Form I-485, then you must submit a copy of your [Form I-797C, Notice of Action](#), also known as your receipt, as evidence that you filed Form I-485 when you file Form I-765 and/or Form I-131.

Which Box to Check in Part 2 of Form I-485

Before filing a Form I-485 based on a family-sponsored or employment-based preference category, check our [Visa Bulletin](#) page to see if your priority date makes you eligible to apply.

If you are the principal applicant, check the appropriate box in **Part 2, Item 2.**, of Form I-485 and check the appropriate box in **Part 2, Item 3.a.** through **3.g.**

If you are the derivative spouse or child of the principal applicant, check the appropriate box in **Part 2, Item 2. and complete Principal Applicant information in Part 2. Item 2.**, of Form I-485 and check the appropriate box in **Part 2, Item 3.a.** through **3.g.**

For more information on the Visa Bulletin or the charts, please go to our [Visa Availability and Priority Dates](#) page.

Premium Processing

You may file Form I-485 and Form I-140 together at the USCIS Dallas Lockbox.

If you are requesting premium processing for Form I-140, you must also file [Form I-907, Request for Premium Processing Service](#). Refer to our [Direct Filing Addresses for Form I-140, Immigrant Petition for Alien Workers](#), page if you want to file Forms I-485, I-140, and I-907 together.

If you are filing Form I-485 based on a pending or approved Form I-140, go to our [Direct Filing Addresses for Form I-485](#) page to see where to file your application.

Read the Employment-Based Preferences chart in the [Department of State's Visa Bulletin](#) page to ensure your priority date is current before you file your application.

Afghan Parolees

If you are an Afghan parolee with an approved [Form I-360, Petition for Amerasian, Widow\(er\), or Special Immigrant](#), as an Afghan employed by or on behalf of the U.S. government or International Security Assistance Force (ISAF) in Afghanistan, or an approved Form DS-157, Petition for Special Immigrant Classification for Afghan SIV Applicants, and you did not complete [Form I-485, Application to Register](#)

[Permanent Residence or Adjust Status](#), we encourage you to file Form I-485 as soon as possible to apply to become a lawful permanent resident and get a Green Card if eligible.

If you are an Afghan parolee with an approved [Form I-360, Petition for Amerasian, Widow\(er\), or Special Immigrant](#), as an Afghan employed by or on behalf of the U.S. government or International Security Assistance Force (ISAF) in Afghanistan, and you did not complete [Form I-485, Application to Register Permanent Residence or Adjust Status](#), at a safe haven, we encourage you to file Form I-485 as soon as possible to apply to become a lawful permanent resident and get a Green Card. You must provide a U.S. address to file Form I-485. If your address changes, you must notify us of your new address within 10 days by submitting Form AR-11, Alien's Change of Address Card. The fastest way to submit your Form AR-11 is [online](#). Special filing instructions apply to those filing Form I-485 in this category. You do not have to pay the filing or biometric services fees for Form I-485 if you were paroled into the United States due to the humanitarian crisis and are applying for adjustment as an Afghan Special Immigrant.

When filing Form I-485, include evidence of an approved Form I-360 petition or a copy of the Chief of Mission approval letter which also indicates approval of your Form DS-157 petition.

Review filing instructions at our [Green Card for an Afghan Who Was Employed by or on Behalf of the U.S. Government](#) page, and see the [instructions for Form I-485](#) for complete filing information.

Attorney or Representative

You may be represented, at no expense to the U.S. government, by an attorney or other authorized representative. Your representative must submit Form G-28, Notice of Entry or Appearance as Attorney or Representative, with your Form I-485. Your representative may also submit Form G-28 at the time of your interview.

Related Links



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